



## TOP FIVE BUYS



**Kashvee Gautam (India, uncapped)**  
₹2 crore to Gujarat Giants.

**Annabel Sutherland (Australia)**  
₹2 crore to Delhi Capitals.

**Vrinda Dinesh (India, uncapped)**  
₹1.3 crore to UP Warriorz.

**Shabnim Ismail (South Africa)**  
₹1.2 crore to Mumbai Indians.

**Phoebe Litchfield (Australia)**  
₹1 crore to Gujarat Giants

**Moment to savour:** Mumbai Indians won the inaugural Women's Premier League, after beating Delhi Capitals in the final. SPORTZPICS/WPL

Challengers Bangalore (RCB) initiated the bid, but Warriorz escalated the price. In the tricky realm of franchise leagues, young players who secure big-money deals have often struggled. But Vrinda does not want to get carried away by the money.

"The price tag is not in my hands," the 22-year-old opener said. "I just want to give my best. At the end of the day, I am just here to play and enjoy the sport."

Vrinda, who played for India-A against England-A in the recent T20 series, is happy that she joined a WPL team led by Alyssa Healy, one of her favourite cricketers.

While some of the top international stars like Chamari

Athapaththu and Deandra Dottin went unsold, Australia's all-rounder Annabel Sutherland was the most expensive overseas player, attracting the joint-highest bid of the auction at ₹2 crore.

The Capitals had a purse of ₹2.25 crore coming into the auction and the franchise exhausted most of that money by acquiring Sutherland, who was earlier released by the Giants.

An intense bidding battle unfolded